TCS Workplace & Return to Office (RTO) Operating Framework

CATEGORY	Workplace Management | Delivery Operations	EFFECTIVE DATE	January 1, 2026	REVIEW CYCLE	Annual Tata Corporate Audit

Article 1. Workplace Operating Framework & Return to Office (RTO) Governance

1.1 Mandatory 5-Day Work from Office, 85% Turnstile Attendance & Campus Presence

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) recognizes that in-person collaboration, physical mentorship, collective problem-solving, and cross-functional teaming within our delivery campuses form the cornerstone of our organizational culture, associate professional development, and client delivery assurance. In accordance with executive leadership directives, all associates are mandated to work full-time (5 days per week) from their designated TCS delivery centres, base branch campuses, or assigned client delivery locations. Remote work and ad-hoc work from home (WFH) have been formally phased out as regular operating modes.

Associates must maintain a minimum in-office attendance compliance of 85% of working days per calendar month, as registered by the automated turnstile access badge-in and badge-out telemetry at TCS campus gates and ODC security doors. Monthly turnstile attendance logs are reconciled electronically on the 1st of each month and transmitted to Delivery Heads (DH) and Unit HR (UHR). Attendance compliance directly governs eligibility for Quarterly Performance Pay (QPP), variable compensation allocations, annual merit increments, project bonus disbursements, and career promotion cycles.

Compliance Parameter	Mandatory Operating Standard	Tracking System	Business Impact
In-Office Working Days	5 Days / Week (Monday to Friday)	Turnstile Access Gates	Baseline condition of employment
Monthly Turnstile Compliance	Minimum 85% of Working Days	Automated Turnstile Telemetry	Eligibility for QPP & Variable Pay
Core Working Shift Hours	9 Hours / Day (including 1h breaks)	Timesheet & Turnstile match	Overtime & shift allowance tracking
Ad-Hoc WFH Availability	Phased Out (Disallowed by default)	Ultimatix Gate Lockout	Marked as Unauthorized / LOP if unapproved
Annual Promotion Linkage	>= 85% Annual In-Office Rate	Talent Review Board	Mandatory gate for grade progression

- Turnstile attendance records cannot be manually altered or overridden by immediate project managers.
- Proxy punching or using another associate's smartcard triggers immediate summary termination under TCoC Clause 4.
- Non-compliance with the 85% monthly attendance threshold results in automatic withholding of the associate's quarterly performance pay.

MANDATORY RETURN TO OFFICE (RTO) ATTENDANCE MANDATE:
Physical campus presence is an essential, non-negotiable term of employment across all TCS delivery units. Associates failing to report to assigned campuses without approved medical accommodations will be placed on formal administrative leave without pay.

Article 2. Standard Shift Hours, Turnstile Telemetry & Working Time Governance

2.1 9-Hour Workday, 45-Hour Week, Shift Schedules & Core Collaboration Windows

The standard operating schedule for full-time associates is 9 consecutive hours per working day (equivalent to 45 hours per standard working week), which includes 8 active delivery/working hours and 1 hour of cumulative meal and refreshment breaks. The standard general shift window operates from 09:00 to 18:00 hours (Monday through Friday). For teams operating across rotational, staggered, or 24x7 mission-critical client support rosters, shift schedules are defined in accordance with client Master Services Agreements (MSA) and approved by the Delivery Centre Head (DCH).

To qualify as a full day's attendance, the duration between the associate's first morning turnstile badge-in and last evening badge-out must reflect a minimum span of 8 hours and 30 minutes on campus. A campus stay between 4.5 hours and 8.5 hours is classified as half-day attendance. Less than 4.5 hours on campus is marked as Absent / Loss of Pay (LOP) unless regularized with sanctioned half-day casual or sick leave on Ultimatix. Core collaboration hours (10:00 to 16:30) require mandatory presence.

Turnstile Stay Duration	Attendance Classification	Payroll Impact	Ultimatix System Action
>= 8 Hours 30 Minutes	Full Working Day Present	100% Full Daily Remuneration	Standard Present marked
4.5 Hours to 8.49 Hours	Half Working Day Present	0.5 Day Pay (Requires 0.5 Day Leave)	Half-day warning alert triggered
< 4.5 Hours on Campus	Classified as Absent	Loss of Pay (LOP) applied	Automated Absence notification
Shift 1 (Morning: 06:00 - 15:00)	Rotational Client Rota	Standard Shift Allowance added	Shift roster code validation
Shift 2 (Afternoon: 14:00 - 23:00)	Rotational Client Rota	Night Transport Cab provided	Drop cab escort security
Shift 3 (Night: 22:00 - 07:00)	Mission Critical 24x7 Rota	Enhanced Night Shift Allowance	Mandatory female associate security escorts

- Turnstile records are synchronized nightly with the corporate SAP/Ultimatix payroll engine.
- Associates must swipe their own smartcard individually; tailgating through open turnstiles is an explicit security violation.
- Night shift transport is provided free of cost to associates working shifts extending beyond 20:00 or starting before 07:00.

CAMPUS SAFETY & TURNSTILE GATE INTEGRITY:
All physical entries and exits through campus security gates, ODC doors, and turnstiles must be logged via smartcard. Turnstile discrepancies must be reconciled within 48 hours via Ultimatix Attendance Regularization with managerial concurrence.

Article 3. Secure Borderless Workspaces (SBWS) Protocol & ODC Security Controls

3.1 Zero-Trust Endpoint Architecture, ODC Clean Floor Policy & Device Governance

The TCS Secure Borderless Workspaces (SBWS) framework governs all enterprise computing infrastructure across on-premise workstations, corporate laptops, virtual desktop environments (VDI), and cloud workstations. All corporate endpoints are locked down with centralized endpoint security agents—including Palo Alto GlobalProtect VPN, Symantec/Trellix Data Loss Prevention (DLP), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, and strict device control policies. The use of unauthorized personal laptops, BYOD devices, external USB mass storage devices, personal hard drives, and mobile hotspot tethering is strictly prohibited.

Within designated Offshore Development Centres (ODCs) and Dedicated Client Facilities (DCFs), associates must adhere strictly to the ODC Clean Floor Mandate. Mobile phones, personal cameras, audio recording devices, USB drives, smart watches with cellular data, and personal storage media must be deposited in secure external locker facilities prior to entering the ODC. Any attempt to photograph computer monitors, extract customer source code, or capture client proprietary data triggers immediate turnstile gate pass revocation and summary dismissal under TCoC Clause 5.

Security Domain	Mandatory SBWS Protocol	Monitoring Technology	Enforcement Consequence
Endpoint USB Ports	Hardware Disablement / Blocked	Symantec / Trellix DLP	Port disabled; alert sent to GSOC
ODC Physical Floor	Clean Floor (No mobiles / cameras)	CCTV & Security Frisking	Locker storage mandatory
Network Access	Corporate Wired LAN / Secured Wi-Fi	802.1X Enterprise Certificate	Rogue networks blocked
Screen Inactivity	Automatic Lock after 3 Minutes	Group Policy Enforcement	Screen lock (Win+L / Ctrl+Cmd+Q)
Data Exfiltration	Strictly Blocked across all channels	DLP Cloud Shadow Monitoring	Immediate security investigation

- Associates must never leave active sessions unlocked or unattended; screens must be locked whenever stepping away from desks.
- Customer proprietary IP must never be forwarded to personal email addresses or hosted on unapproved personal cloud drives.
- Physical security guards conduct random spot-checks at ODC turnstiles to verify compliance with the Clean Floor policy.

ODC INTEGRITY & ZERO DATA LEAKAGE MANDATE:
Customer trust is paramount. Bypassing ODC physical controls, bringing mobile recording devices onto the delivery floor, or attempting unauthorized code exfiltration constitutes criminal breach of trust and results in immediate legal prosecution.

Article 4. Temporary Medical Accommodations & Exceptional Telecommuting Approval

4.1 Exceptional WFH Eligibility, Approval Matrix & Strict Time-Bound Limits

In strictly defined circumstances where an associate suffers from acute temporary physical immobility (e.g., severe orthopedic fractures, major post-operative convalescence, high-risk pregnancy complications certified by an obstetrician, or contagious infections requiring medical isolation), a temporary, time-bound telecommuting exception may be requested. Exceptional WFH is not an entitlement and is granted solely upon formal medical validation and project delivery viability.

Temporary WFH requests must be submitted through Ultimatix with supporting medical documentation from a Registered Medical Practitioner (RMP). Approval requires the dual concurrence of the Delivery Centre Head (DCH) and the Unit HR Head (UHR). The maximum duration for any single medical telecommuting approval is 15 consecutive working days. Extensions beyond 15 days require formal case review by the TCS Occupational Health Centre (OHC) Medical Board and Delivery Head (DH) signoff. In no circumstances may temporary WFH exceed 60 calendar days within a rolling 12-month period.

Medical / Accommodation Scenario	Maximum WFH Span Allowed	Required Medical Documentation	Approval Authority
Acute Orthopedic Immobility	Up to 15 Working Days	Orthopedic Surgeon Hospital Certificate	DCH & Unit HR Head
High-Risk Pregnancy Bedrest	Up to 30 Working Days	Gynecologist Ultrasound & Clinical Report	OHC Medical Board & DCH
Severe Post-Operative Recovery	Up to 15 Working Days	Hospital Discharge Summary & Treatment Plan	DCH & Unit HR Head
Contagious Medical Quarantine	Up to 7 Working Days	OHC Certified Infectious Isolation Notice	OHC Medical Officer
Convenience / Commute Reasons	Zero (Strictly Prohibited)	Not Applicable (Inadmissible)	Auto-rejected by Ultimatix

- Associates on approved temporary WFH must remain accessible via Microsoft Teams throughout standard core working hours.
- Working remotely from public cafes, hotel lobbies, unencrypted co-working spaces, or shared public Wi-Fi is strictly banned.
- Attendance during approved temporary medical WFH is mapped with full system telemetry and JIRA/timesheet deliverables.

EXCEPTIONAL MEDICAL GOVERNANCE PROTOCOL:
Requests citing commute distance, traffic congestion, personal convenience, or domestic routine are strictly ineligible for WFH. Such requests are automatically rejected by the Ultimatix workflow engine without supervisory review.

Article 5. Prohibition of International Remote Work & Data Sovereignty Mandate

5.1 Cross-Border Telecommuting Ban, Tax Nexus Risk & Data Residency Legislation

Associates are strictly prohibited from performing TCS or client professional duties from any foreign country or international jurisdiction outside their contracted employment location without formal overseas deputation (Global Deputation - GD). Work from Anywhere (WFA) abroad or unauthorized international telecommuting constitutes an illegal violation of international tax laws, creates permanent corporate establishment (PE) tax liabilities for TCS, and breaches client contractual data residency.

Client Master Services Agreements (MSA) and international data privacy statutes—including the EU General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), US HIPAA, and international export control regimes—strictly prohibit accessing customer production systems, source code repositories, or personally identifiable information (PII) from unapproved international IP addresses. Any associate found connecting to TCS networks or client systems via foreign IP addresses triggers automatic GlobalProtect VPN network blacklisting and immediate termination for cause under TCoC Clause 1.

Risk Category	Statutory & Regulatory Driver	TCS Policy Prohibition	Corporate Liability
Corporate Tax Nexus	International Permanent Establishment (PE)	Absolute ban on foreign telecommuting	Multi-million dollar corporate tax fines
Data Sovereignty	GDPR Art 44-50 / HIPAA / CCPA	No unauthorized international data transit	Severe regulatory penalties & MSA loss
Immigration Compliance	Foreign Tourist / Non-immigrant Visas	Working on tourist visa strictly illegal	Deportation & blacklisting by consulates
Client Contractual Breach	MSA Dedicated Delivery Location Clause	Breach of ODC exclusivity covenants	Contract termination & client damages

- Connecting to TCS corporate VPN from international foreign locations without approved GD letter triggers immediate GSOC alert.
- Associates traveling abroad for personal vacations must leave corporate laptops and hardware in secure custody at their base branch.
- Any associate traveling internationally with corporate assets without written Overseas Transit Authorization will be intercepted.

DATA SOVEREIGNTY & EXPORT CONTROL ENFORCEMENT:
Unauthorized international remote work places TCS and our enterprise clients in severe legal jeopardy under foreign tax and export control authorities. Violators face immediate summary dismissal, financial restitution, and legal referral.

Article 6. Workplace Ergonomics, Occupational Health & OHC Facility Standards

6.1 Ergonomic Standards, OHC Campus Facilities & Health Risk Mitigation

TCS is committed to maintaining world-class workplace ergonomics, health safety, and wellness infrastructure across all campuses. All delivery centres provide height-adjustable pneumatic task chairs, dual-monitor workstations with ergonomic viewing angles, anti-glare ambient lighting, central HVAC climate control with HEPA filtration, and designated ergonomic collaboration pods.

Every major TCS campus features a fully staffed 24x7 Occupational Health Centre (OHC) with qualified medical doctors, nursing staff, emergency ICU ambulances, basic life support (BLS) equipment, and tie-ups with leading multi-speciality tertiary hospitals within a 5-kilometer radius. Associates experiencing physical discomfort, repetitive strain injury (RSI), or occupational stress may avail ergonomic posture assessments and preventive physiotherapy sessions at the OHC free of cost.

OHC Healthcare Service	Campus Availability	Operating Standard	Emergency Protocols
General Medical Consultation	24x7 across all major campuses	Qualified MBBS Medical Officers	Walk-in & scheduled appointment
Emergency ICU Ambulance	Dedicated on-campus vehicle	Paramedic & oxygen support equipped	Instant transit to tertiary hospital
Ergonomic Posture Clinic	Weekly specialist sessions	Physiotherapist evaluation	Workstation adjustments recommended
Annual Health Check-Up	Annual drive for all associates	Comprehensive pathology & vitals	Free under TCS-HIS wellness banner
Fit4Life Fitness Facilities	On-campus gymnasiums	Certified fitness instructors	Cardio, weights & yoga facilities

- Emergency response alarms and medical call buttons are installed across all delivery floors and ODCs.
- Associates are encouraged to take brief 5-minute eye relaxation breaks every 60 minutes of intensive monitor work.
- Campus cafeterias are audited monthly by food safety inspectors to ensure absolute nutritional quality and hygiene.

FIT4LIFE ASSOCIATE WELLNESS INITIATIVE:
TCS Fit4Life fosters a culture of fitness and preventive wellness. Associates are encouraged to participate in annual marathon events, corporate step challenges, and campus wellness sports leagues to promote active lifestyle habits.

Document Governance, Audit History & Tata Code of Conduct Authorization

Revision	Release Date	Author / Department	Summary of Regulatory Changes
v1.0	Jan 15, 2024	TCS Global HR Taskforce	Initial codification of associate policies aligned with Tata Code of Conduct (TCoC) and statutory labor standards.
v2.0	Nov 10, 2024	Corporate Ethics & Compliance	Updated statutory maternity/paternity protections, POSH ICC inquiry guidelines, and bereavement leave rules.
v3.0	Jan 01, 2025	TCS Total Rewards Council	Bouquet of Benefits (BoB) tax optimization, NPS corporate Tier 1 integration, and TCS Health Insurance Scheme (TCS-HIS) enhancement.
v4.0	Oct 15, 2025	Delivery Operations & Workplace	Codified 5-day return-to-office (RTO) attendance linkage with quarterly performance pay (QPP) and Secure Borderless Workspaces (SBWS).
v6.0	Jan 01, 2026	Chief Human Resources Officer & Legal	Annual consolidation. ISO 27001 ISMS controls, Generative AI acceptable usage governance, and Ultimatix ESS automation.

Signatory Role	Authorized Representative	Approval Status	Digital Signature Hash
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